# EXTRACT FROM – TANTRĀLOKA 6
## Svacchandanāth – Aghoranāth – Anantabhaṭṭāraka

*kālāgnirbhuvi saṁhartā māyānte kālatattvarāṭ /*
*śrīkaṇṭho mūla ekatra sṛṣṭi-saṁhāra-kārakaḥ //171*

Now, the great handlers of these four spheres of the world.

Kālāgnirudra is creator and destroyer in *pṛthvī aṇḍa* [earth egg].

Up to *māyā* Śrīkaṇṭhanātha is creator and destroyer, [he is] the king of the element of time. And Śrīkaṇṭhanātha handles *māyā aṇḍa* and *prakṛti aṇḍa*.

*śrīmānaghoraḥ śaktyante saṁhartā sṛṣṭikṛcca saḥ //172*

Aghoranātha, i.e., Anantabhaṭṭāraka is another Rudra.

**SCHOLAR:** Aghora here is Anantabhaṭṭāraka?

**SWAMIJI:** Anantabhaṭṭāraka is Aghoranātha [Lord of the Aghora śaktis].

**JOHN:** So he is higher than . . . ?

**SWAMIJI:** He is highest, not higher, highest. He creates and destroys up to *śakti tattva*. So *śaktyaṇḍa* is created and destroyed by Aghoranātha.

*tatsṛṣṭau sṛṣṭisaṁhārā niḥsaṁkhyā jagatāṁ yataḥ / 173a*

And in this function of creating and destroying, creations and destruction's take place numberlessly. And *antarbhūtā* and these creations and destruction's which have taken place numberlessly in previous three circles, i.e., *pṛthvī*, *prakṛti* and *māyā*; these destruction's and creations exist in the fourth destruction and creation.

*antarbhūtāstataḥ śāktī mahāsṛṣṭirudāhṛtā //173*

So this creation of *śaktyaṇḍa* is supposed to be the highest.

**JOHN:** Is this Aghoranātha the same as Anantabhaṭṭāraka?

**SWAMIJI:** Anantabhaṭṭāraka, yes.

**JOHN:** Aghoranātha means?

**SWAMIJI:** Aghoranātha, it is . . . he handles, he is the immediate assistant boss of Lord Śiva.

**SCHOLAR:** And he is the lord of *dakṣiṇa srota*?

**SWAMIJI:** Yes.

He is the immediate boss – not boss – assistant, immediate assistant, he assists. He is agent for creation and destruction and protection, all the three.

And he himself conducts only revealing and the concealing – Lord Śiva. Lord Śiva has not taken this trouble.

**JOHN:** Of these other three, *sṛṣṭi*, . . .

**SWAMIJI:** Creation, destruction and protection.

**JOHN:** So Lord Śiva handles *tirodhana*, this obscuration and grace.

**SWAMIJI:** Yes, He puts this [other] work for Aghoranātha, Anantabhaṭṭāraka.

**SCHOLAR:** He delegates himself in the form of Aghora, to do this.

**SWAMIJI:** Yes, but revealing and concealing couldn't be conducted without Lord Śiva. Because in revealing and in concealing you have nothing to see, there is no distinction. If he wants to reveal his nature to you, he can do it, there will be no cry, there will be no crisis.

But Aghoranātha has to create and protect and destroy according to the theory of our actions, because he does according to our *karmas*. But our actions are not calculated by Lord Śiva, he doesn't care for actions . . . just [he does] as he pleases.

If he pleases he can reveal his nature to that most inferior being. If he pleases he can conceal his nature from the greatest pundit scholar, he will be no more existing as a realized soul. This he does himself without consideration of our actions.

So it is very easy to get elevated by Lord Śiva, and it is very difficult to get elevated by Lord Śiva at the same time.

So he does not care for our qualities. He cares for what . . . His will!

If he likes he can reveal, what does it matter to him.

This is the greatness in Lord Śiva, there is no *karma* theory in between; he does not care for our actions or qualities. If you have no qualities, there is possibility of his grace, and, if you have qualities, there is possibility of his grace.

Any time, any moment, it can happen at any moment . . . He is so great!

And another Lord Śiva in the formation of Anantabhaṭṭāraka is not great, he is dependent to our actions. According to our actions he will create us, protect us and destroyed us.

[Extract from Tantrāloka 9]

So, Anantabhaṭṭāraka is PA to Lord Śiva, i.e., just assistant, [personal] assistant Rudra of Lord Śiva; he assists Lord Śiva in inferior creation.

**STEPHANIE:** Is he a Lord?

**SWAMIJI:** He is Lord he is Śiva. He is Śiva but he is called Anantabhaṭṭāraka. But he functions only in inferior creation – in creation, protection and destruction. And in revealing and concealing Lord Śiva handles himself, he reveals and he conceals . . . he?

**JOHN:** Reveals and conceals himself.

**SWAMIJI:** Yes.

[Question:] "But, if Anantabhaṭṭāraka is some other personality, Śiva is some other personality, and that individual ignorant person is another personality . . . where remains that monistic Shaivism?"

"That monistic Shaivism is finished!"

But he says:

*aṇavo nāma naivānyat-prakāśātmā maheśvaraḥ* //144//
*cidacid-rūpatābhāsī pudgalaḥ kṣetravit-paśuḥ* /

These individual are not separate, in fact these individuals are not separated from Lord Śiva, these individuals are only offshoots of Lord Śiva.

So there is . . . monistic thought of Shaivism stands!

Because when all individual are only offshoots of Lord Śiva, [then] they are not separate from Lord Śiva.

Only there is this difference between Lord Śiva and individuals, that *cit acit rūpatābhāsī,* Lord Śiva's Being is absolute consciousness, whereas the being of individual is unconscious of his Self.

And Lord Śiva, when he is unconscious he is called individual – that is the difference.

[ END ]

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